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Graduate Recruitment Team

EDF Trading

80 Victoria Street

London SW1E 5JL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Commercial Graduate Programme (September 2027) in London, with a particular interest in gas and power trading. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. EDF Trading's gas desk is one of the largest wholesale natural gas traders in Europe, and European gas is the market I have chosen to study in depth for my dissertation.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously; my lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 were built on disciplined bet sizing and a strict bankroll rule.

EDF Trading stands out to me because it sits where physical energy meets financial markets, with a gas trading team among Europe's largest wholesale traders and a power trading team that uses data analysis to find opportunities in the market. My dissertation forecasts TTF volatility from daily storage, market and news data, and I would like to learn how a trading business turns exactly those inputs into positions and hedges for one of Europe's largest generators.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan